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INTERVIEW

« We have a car that is better
than we've ever had before »

JAMES VOWLES

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The name Williams has been synonymous with Formula One for half a century. Founded by Sir Frank Williams in the late '70s, the Grove-based outfit

dominated the sport for two decades, winning seven Drivers' and nine Constructors' titles before the turn of the millennium.

The British team has found the going tough over the last few years, finishing dead last in the standings four times between 2018 and 2022, collecting just 39 points over the duration.

Under the ownership of US-based Dorilton Capital, and with former Mercedes Motorsport Strategy Director James Vowles at the helm since 2023, Williams has made rapid strides. The constructor eclipsed its 2024 points tally within four races of the 2025 season and looks set to challenge for fifth in the standings for the first time since 2017.

Taking over from the Williams family, who nurtured the team for 43 years, is no easy task, but Vowles has managed to instil confidence into the struggling outfit in his role as Team Principal.

In an exclusive chat with *Sportstar* on the sidelines of the Saudi Arabian Grand Prix, Vowles spoke at length about the team's progress, his data-driven approach, preparing the garage for the soon-to-arrive regulations, the future of the sport, and more.

Five races into 2025, Williams has gotten off to a fast start compared to the last four seasons. How's the mood in the garage?

Highly positive. I think we always have to remember where we've come from. It is a privilege and a pleasure to be racing with a car that can score points every weekend — and it is — with two world-class drivers. You'd be surprised how

much that carries you through the tireless and sleepless nights.

You've spoken about the continuous improvement you looked to bring when you took on this role in 2023. Two years on, do you think you're on the right track?

Yeah, I think the direction of travel is a good one. This car isn't what we've put our focus on. We've just been fixing some foundational issues, putting in system software, infrastructure, culture, technology, people — and it's nice to see that the car is moving up and corresponds to that. We have a car that is better than we've ever had before. I think the real test is breaking away from the midfield, closer to the front.

You touched upon your two drivers, Alex Albon and Carlos Sainz. Both of them are very experienced in the top tier of